

INT. BUILDING HALLWAY - DAY

Light enters through a window. MIRA(23F) holds a heavy box in one hand, trying to open door with other. The box shakes, keys fall down.

ANGLE ON keys falling down

Hands pick keys up - DEV(25M) picks it up and holds them out.

DEV
(very softly)
Careful. These locks are tricky to open. You must push them down while turning.

MIRA
(smiles for a second)
Thanks. First day here, and already running into problems.

Door swings open. Mira steps in

DEV
Don't worry, you get used to it. Took me a while too. I live down the hall. I am Dev.

Dev starts walking away

MIRA
(shouting a bit)
Nice to meet you Dev, I am Mira

Shuts her door

CUT TO BLACK

EXT. PARKING LOT - NEXT MORNING

Mira walks while looking at her phone. A cycle whooshes past her. She drops her phone.

ANGLE ON: AARAV(22M, grinning)

MIRA
(she screams)
Are you blind!

Aarav stops cycle beside her

AARAV
(mockingly)
You are one to speak. At least look away from your screen while walking.

Mira picks up her phone

MIRA
You better hope it's not cracked.

Mira glares. Aarav shrugs and rides away. His cycle nearly avoids two cars.

MIRA (CONT'D)
(to herself)
Yeah, yeah run away now.

INT. MIRA'S APARTMENT - EVENING

Boxes half unopened lie around the room. Mira hears the door knock and opens it

Dev stands on the other side. He looks tired. dressed for work, carrying a bag.

DEV
(looks up and down at
Mira)
Hi, just wanted to stop by and see
how you are doing with all the
unpacking.

MIRA
Going fine. You look exhausted, why
don't you come in.

DEV
(stepping in)
I sure am. It was a taxing day at
work. The new intern could not
figure out what to do.

MIRA
Would you like a glass of water?

DEV(CONT'D)
(Nodding his head)
I stayed out late, helping the poor
chap. Everyone's so tough on you
when you are new.

Mira hand him a glass. She goes back towards the boxes

MIRA
(sighing)
I get that, I am new here and I know
no one expect you and the grandma
who lives on the first floor. My
faucet's been leaking and I can't
get a plumber to come fix it.

Mira takes out some books and utensils from a box.

DEV

Don't worry, it's tough to fit in at first. And about the plumber I give you my guy's number

MIRA

(busy unpacking)

Oh that means a lot. It's good to have someone in your corner.

Mira takes stuff out and takes them by the window. She looks outside

Camera pans outside the window

It is dark outside, in the dim front lights of a car, we see AARAV standing with a silhouette . He is exchanging cash for something in a bag. He lights a cigarette with ease.

Camera back to the room

MIRA (CONT'D)

Hey come here, do you know that guy? I ran into him this morning. He looks too shady to live here.

DEV

(also looking out)

Yes, that's Aarav. He is a troublemaker and unfortunately yes he does live here. In fact on this floor as far as I know.

MIRA

I will definitely be avoiding

Dev heads for the door. Mira follows him

DEV

(sincerely)

See you later Mira, if you need anything you know where to find me

He exits politely. She exhales, grateful

EXT. APARTMENT PARKING LOT - MORNING

Mira exits for work. A car is parked badly, blocking another. Aarav's asleep inside, seat reclined, sunglasses on, music still faintly playing.

Mira shakes her head, muttering to herself.

MIRA

Unbelievable.

Behind her, Dev exits quietly, well-dressed, carrying a briefcase. He nods politely to her. Mira smiles back.

INT. APARTMENT HALLWAY - NIGHT

Mira struggles with a leaky water filter. Dev arrives, precise toolkit in hand.

DEV
(calmly)
It's the valve. The manufacturer
must have been cutting costs.

He kneels, repairing it swiftly.
Mira watches, impressed.

MIRA
How do you know all this?

DEV
(smiles faintly)
I like fixing things. Makes the
world... feel more ordered.

Mira nods. His gaze lingers on her longer than feels natural. She blinks, unsettled. He finally looks away.

EXT. ROADSIDE TEA STALL - AFTERNOON

Mira hurries with folders and books, trips. Papers scatter. Cars pass by. Aarav, smoking nearby, stubs his cigarette and rushes over. He blocks traffic with wild hand gestures.

AARAV
Slow down! Not every day's a race!

He kneels, helps gather her papers. A passing driver HONKS.

AARAV (shouting)
Yeah, yeah, honk away! That will get you going faster.

Mira laughs despite herself. Aarav hands her the last folder, smudged with dust. His grin softens.

AARAV (quieter)
Be careful. The world will not stop when you fall, you must make it stop.

Mira sees sincerity in his eyes. She nods, touched.

INT. DEV'S APARTMENT - EVENING

Dev and Mira sit with coffee. He listens politely as she speaks about her job.

MIRA

It's exhausting... but worth it. I like it. That's what matters, even if people don't notice.

DEV

(flat, thoughtful)

People don't notice unless you make them. Order needs to be seen.

Dev takes her hand gently but firmly.

DEV (CONT'D)

Stick close to people who won't waste your effort. Some of them aren't worth it.

His tone borders on protective – almost too much. Mira hesitates before nodding.

EXT. BUILDING COURTYARD - NIGHT

Aarav plays with a stray dog, tossing a stick. Mira steps outside, arms crossed, amused.

MIRA

You don't seem like a dog person.

AARAV

(busy playing)

I'm not a lot of things. Doesn't mean I can't try.

Their eyes meet – a beat of unspoken warmth. Aarav laughs unexpectedly.

AARAV (CONT'D)

Besides, he's the only one here who doesn't yell at me.

Mira laughs, shaking her head.

INT. MIRA'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

Mira cooks. A loud KNOCK. Dev enters without waiting for long. He scans the messy kitchen counter.

DEV

(soft but critical)

Careful. Oil splatters. You are ruining your walls.

He moves to take the pan, almost uninvited. Mira gently takes it back.

MIRA
(frustrated)
I've got it. Why are you here?

Dev pauses, eyes fixed on her, intensity building. He finally softens with a small smile.

DEV
(nervously)
I just... I wanted to see you. I
wanted to hear your voice.

Mira blushes. But unease lingers beneath the kindness.

EXT. ROOFTOP - NIGHT

Mira finds Aarav sitting on the edge, feet dangling over the edge, city lights sparkle below. A beer bottle beside him.

MIRA
(worried and shocked)
You'll fall.

AARAV
Then I will get to beat gravity for
a second. Worth it.

He grins, but his eyes are heavy. Mira sits cautiously sits beside him

Camera goes behind them. We see their backs, the night sky above. We can hear distant voices and cars swooshing past.

MIRA
Why do you do that? Pretend you
don't care?

AARAV
Maybe I'm scared people won't like
the guy who does.

He seems vulnerable. Mira sees him differently now. Aarav quickly masks it with a laugh.

AARAV (CONT'D)
Besides, rooftops are cheaper than
therapy.

Mira laughs, though her eyes linger on him with quiet empathy.

MIRA
(handing Aarav her phone)
Here, if you ever need therapy you
know who to contact.

Aarav takes her phone, pretends to drop it.

MIRA (CONT'D)
(Jabs him in the side)
Be careful.

INT. DEV'S APARTMENT - NIGHT

Mira and Dev. The air is heavy.

Mira returns from the kitchen.

MIRA
(sweating)
The pasta is talking too long to
cook. Should I turn the flame to
high

Dev sets her phone down on the table – screen unlocked.

DEV
(controlled)
Why is he messaging you?

Mira freezes. She grabs her phone, flustered.

MIRA
You went through my–

DEV
(cutting her off, voice
calm but cold)
I had to. You don't see what he is.
Reckless. Dangerous. He doesn't
deserve–

MIRA
(angry now)
You don't get to decide that for me.

Dev's jaw tightens. His mask of kindness cracks for the
first time. Mira recoils slightly, realising the edge
beneath his calm demeanour.

DEV
You said you would stay away from
him. And now you are texting him.

MIRA
He is a friend. Just like you. Why
are you so bothered about my life.

DEV
I care about you. I do. I even
warned everyone not to disturb you.
I wouldn't want you getting hurt.

MIRA
(shaking)
You did what! No wonder, no one in
the building talked to me. You had
no right.

DEV
(trying to sound calm)
Don't be like this, I did this for
your own good. I want you to like
me. Only me.

MIRA
Since when have you become so
possessive

Dev goes over to Mira grabs her arm, tightly.

DEV
I don't want you to be with anyone
but me. No one should come between
us

A loud hiss comes from the kitchen. Breaking the tension.
The pasta has boiled.

Mira grabs her phone and rushes out the door.

EXT. STREET - NIGHT

Mira storms out of the building, shaken. Aarav stands
under a streetlight, holding a takeaway bag. He spots her,
concerned.

AARAV
You look like hell. Want noodles?

She laughs tension breaking for a moment. He hands her the
bag, softer now.

AARAV (CONT'D)
Don't let him mess with your head.
You're not a puppet he can control.

MIRA
Why do you care? You barely know me.

Aarav shrugs, avoids her gaze, then looks up with
seriousness

AARAV
Because when I see you, I want to
be... better. And that scares me.

Silence. Mira's eyes soften.

INT. APARTMENT LOBBY - NIGHT

Mira enters, finds Dev waiting in the dark.
He speaks through the silence

DEV
You've been with him.

MIRA
(firmly)
I don't need your permission.

DEV
(steps closer, voice
rising)
He's a bad influence, he'll ruin
you. I won't let that happen.

His intensity is frightening. Mira walks past.

EXT. ROOFTOP - NIGHT

Mira pacing, shaken. Suddenly – Aarav appears, carrying
two cans of soda. He sits beside her quietly.

AARAV
I'm not perfect. Hell, I'm
definitely half the mess he says I
am. But I'll never tell you who to
be.

Mira exhales, eyes glistening. She slowly takes his hand.
She looks at him with a mix of relief and trust.

Camera goes over them, showing a shot of the building.
CUT TO BLACK

INT. LOBBY - ANOTHER NIGHT

The CAMERA MOVES IN SLOWLY
Mira walks alone through the lobby. A painting of broken
glass stops her. She studies it. Behind her, voices murmur
– Aarav's laugh rings faintly, not directed at her but
near, Dev is absent.

The camera lingers on Mira. She smiles faintly, free.
FADE OUT.